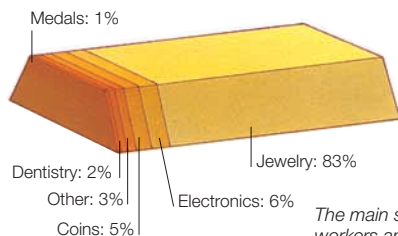


DIGGING FOR GOLD

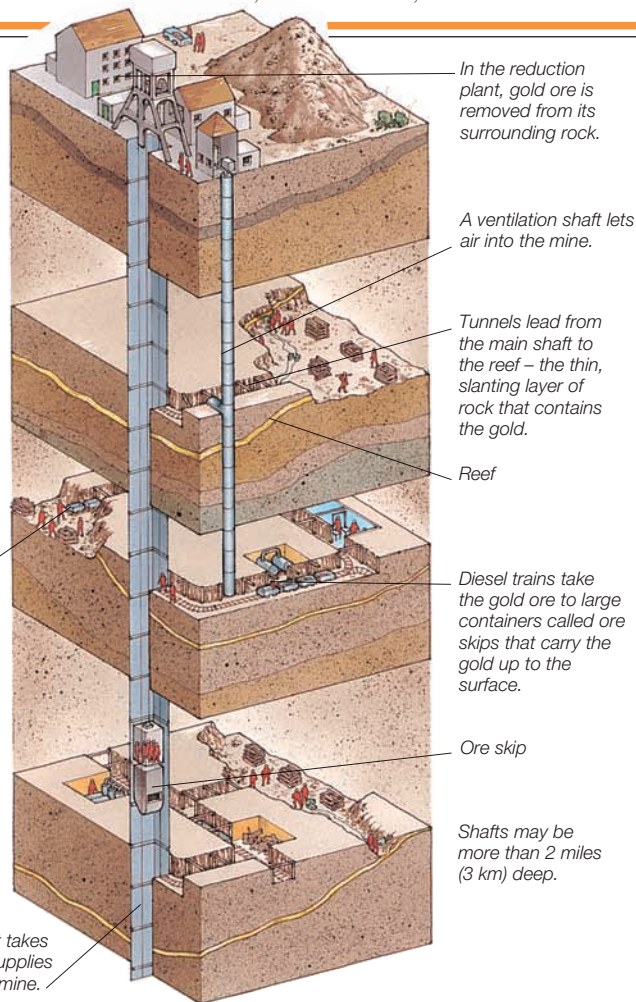
Over the last 100 years, the Witwatersrand gold field around Johannesburg has produced almost half the world's gold, and still accounts for more than 30 percent of the world's total output each year. Diamonds and other minerals are also mined in huge quantities, and the country has a large manufacturing industry and financial sector. As a result, South Africa has the strongest and most advanced economy in Africa. However, population growth and rising unemployment are putting the economy under pressure.

Huge underground rooms known as stoped-out areas are created by drilling and blasting the surrounding rock.

What the gold is used for



The main shaft takes workers and supplies down into the mine.



In the reduction plant, gold ore is removed from its surrounding rock.

A ventilation shaft lets air into the mine.

Tunnels lead from the main shaft to the reef – the thin, slanting layer of rock that contains the gold.

Reef

Diesel trains take the gold ore to large containers called ore skips that carry the gold up to the surface.

Ore skip

Shafts may be more than 2 miles (3 km) deep.



SPORTS

Under apartheid, sporting facilities were segregated and black and white players belonged to different teams. As a result, South Africa was banned from international sports competitions. With the ending of apartheid, sports became multiracial and South African teams were allowed once more to compete in world sports events. Since then, the national football team have played in FIFA World Cups and will host the tournament in 2010.

SWAZILAND

THE KINGDOM OF SWAZILAND is dominated by its powerful neighbor, South Africa, relying on it for much of its wealth and energy supplies. Swaziland's main export is sugarcane, although it also exports wood pulp, coal, and asbestos. The king of Swaziland holds great power, running its affairs as head of government and appointing many members of its parliament. His power is reflected in his title, *Ngwenyama*, meaning "lion."



The coronation of King Mswati III in 1986

LESOTHO

ENTIRELY SURROUNDED BY South Africa, the mountainous kingdom of Lesotho is the only country in Africa where all the land is above 3,300 ft (1,000 m). Its main natural resource is water. A huge hydroelectric plant currently being built will eventually supply all of Lesotho's energy needs as well as vast quantities of water for South Africa. Until then, Lesotho is economically dependent on its wealthy neighbor.



MOHAIR SPINNING

The mountainous terrain of Lesotho is ideal for rearing goats, whose mohair wool is much prized. Using foot-powered treadle wheels, women spin the mohair into yarn to make finely woven material for clothes and other products.

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